

PHOTOSYNTHESIS

Pilot: "Picture Perfect"

by

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Series

Follow the musical adventures of a transplant, her son Parsley, his pear neighbor, and their picture perfect friends in the garden community of Dirty City, Woodwork.

Episode

BEGIN MAIN TITLES

The theme song "Photosynthesis" plays over a montage of the series' highlights. The sequence ends with a camera FLASH!

A Polaroid camera ejects a developing photo of the families and their community. The PHOTOSYNTHESIS title graphic appears embossed on the camera body. On the photo's white border, handwritten text reads: Created by David Quang Pham (and _).

END MAIN TITLES

INT. SALONTRO - PARSLEY'S BEDROOM - MORNING

The group photo flips to reveal its backside: a postcard-style image of the DIRTY CITY gateway. Its sign proudly declares: "The Cleanest City in the Garden Nation."

In front, PARSLEY RAM (11), a sprout in brown overalls with bushy green hair and human-like limbs, poses besides PYRUS CRABAPPLE (13), a pear with limbs in a tan hoodie dress.

A pair of green hands layers photos on the floor. A shot of the kids in front of the SALONTRO salon is placed over Dirty City. Next comes a photo of the FIGLEAF nightclub. The hands continue to build a collage, rotating through many snapshots.

PARSLEY (O.S.)

Picture this: a scrapbook of every plot of land we've ever visited-

PYRUS (O.S.)

And ones we've been uprooted from!

PARSLEY (O.S.)

(Earnestedly)

Yes, those too. We've seen it all in the nation of Woodwork. From our home at Salontro to the clubs in Dirty City, all the way to Woody Holly. We even pranked President Pumpkin Eater at the Green House! We should cherish these memories.

PYRUS (O.S.)

Boring! Let's not forget the embarrassing ones, too!

A hand slams down a photo of Parsley in awkward gnome-style swim trunks while Pyrus stands by him, laughing hysterically.

Parsley and Pyrus sit on the floor, buried in seas of photos.

PARSLEY

Lucky for you. Lawn gnomes are all
the rage.

PYRUS

Stay mad, little herb!

The kids break into a playful fight, swatting at each other
with the loose photos.

Across the room, BOMBUS, cat-like pet bee, is curled up in a
hive-shaped bed. The moment sunlight hits their fuzz, they
vibrate like an alarm clock.

BOMBUS

Buzz! Buzz! Buzz! Buzz! Buzz! Buzz!

PYRUS

Bombus, snooze! Snooooooooozzzzzzzeeee.

The buzzing stops. Bombus wakes up, gives a tiny shake, and
flies around the kids before settling comfortably on Pyrus's
head like a hat.

RAU (O.S.)

Ready for school, Parsley?!

The voice belongs to RAU RAM, a warm but firm cilantro mom.

PARSLEY

Ready as a plum, mom!

A car honks from the street.

MALUS (O.S.)

I ain't got all day, Pyrus!

That's MALUS CRABAPPLE, a flamboyant yet impatient apple.

PYRUS

Shut your wormhole, Malus!

PARSLEY

Sprout, if I ever spoke to my mom
like that, she'd-

Rau barges in. She's a vibrant cilantro with red hands and
gleaming hair. She wears a look that's both cheery and scary.

RAU

She'd what, son?!

Pyrus inches away, leaning in to whisper in Parsley's ear.

PYRUS

Who needs bullies when you've got a tiger plant for a mom?

RAU

Don't call a cilantro that, *pear*. Besides, your unty will eat you up if you don't get out there.

Rau waves out the window.

EXT. SALONTRO - CONTINUOUS

Parked at the curb is a wagon-style car. Malus (50s), a vibrant red apple in a flamboyant suit, leans against the door and waves back with a dramatic flair.

INT. SALONTRO - PARSLEY'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Rau whips out her Polaroid camera, framing the kids in the lens.

RAU

Don't soil yourself, especially today. It's picture day!
(Singing the jingle)
PHOTOSYNTHESIS! PHOTOSYNTHESIS!
PHOTO!

FLASH!

EXT. ROOTIMENTARY SCHOOL - DAY

The school is a massive greenhouse built into the hollow of an ancient stump. Ivy walkways connect classrooms, and the playground is a lush sprawl of lily pads and climbing vines.

Students of every genus imaginable, from tiny succulents in strollers to towering sunflowers, bustle through the entrance, with polished leaves and groomed petals.

In the crowd, Rau adjusts Parsley's overalls.

RAU

Listen to me. This photo is more important than ever. Make this the best picture day.

PARSLEY

Mom, relax. Between the sun and the soil, everyday is photosynthesis.

RAU

Not like this. This year, your portrait is not going into the bin with the common houseplants. As a tutor, your picture will be pinned amongst the garden's elite.

OCI (O.S.)

Parsley has been a total lifesaver as our star tutor this summer.

Rau turns and finds OCI BASIL standing there. He is a gleaming, aromatic herb teacher with a smile give any plant a heart. Rau's eyes sparkle instantly and insanely.

OCI (CONT'D)

Your little sprout is looking sharper than ever, Ms. Ram.

RAU

Well, I'm just trying to impress you, Oci- I mean! My son is very impressive, Mr. Basil.

OCI

I can see where he gets it from.

Rau blushes uncontrollably, like beet red.

OCI (CONT'D)

Oh, hey Pyrus!

Oci walks away into the crowd of plants.

Pyrus saunters up from behind Rau, looking unimpressed.

PYRUS

Lil herb, you look like a total sneezewort in that outfit!

PARSLEY

I always wear this.

RAU

Oh sprouts, look at the time. I should get back to the salon. Got new customers who need their leaves trimmed.

Rau plants a motherly kiss on Parsley's bushy hair and hurries off towards the street.

PYRUS

Your mama has it bad for pesto guy.

PARSLEY

(Groaning)

Can we please just get through one
day without you making it weird?

Pyrus leads the way towards the vine-covered entrance of the school. They pass a group of popular Roses, busy misting themselves with glittery dew.

PYRUS

Careful, Roses! Any more glitter
and you'll trigger a solar flare!

The Roses scoff in unison. Parsley pulls Pyrus away, heading into the bustling hallway where the lockers are birch logs. They reach a door marked STUDIO P.

A long line of students snakes down the hall. Every few seconds, a bright flash of light leaks out from under the door.

PARSLEY

Hope my hair stays bushy. Mom says
"flat leaves lead to flat lives."

PYRUS

Relax, lil herb. You look picture
perfect. Or at least... perfect for
a plant in a grocery store.

The door creaks open. A student with a wilted petal trudges out, looking defeated.

HANDLER (O.S.)

Parsley Ram.

Parsley takes a deep breath, smooths his overalls, and enters the room.

INT. ROOTIMENTARY SCHOOL - PHOTO ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The room is dimly lit, except for the bright studio lights aimed at a solitary stool. A mysterious figure is draped under a black velvet cloth behind a vintage camera.

Parsley points towards the stool.

PARSLEY

Uh, right here?

RAU

Center of frame. The attention.
Right where you belong, son.

PARSLEY

Mom?!

Flash!

Rau whips the cloth off her head, emerging with a grin.

RAU

I'll call that one: "Shock Value."

PARSLEY

What are you doing here?! You're supposed to be at Salontro!

RAU

And leave your future to chance?
I'm making sure you stay picture-perfect.

PARSLEY

But but but the school hired a professional. Where are they?

RAU

Yeah, well, the "professional" takes photos like a clumsy seedling. I simply... offered to cover their shift. And they get ten perfect off a Salontro merchandise on their next visit.

Rau circles Parsley, snapping photos rapidly.

RAU (CONT'D)

Chin up! Leaves out! Don't let your chlorophyll sag!

PARSLEY

Mom, the whole school can hear you!

RAU

Good! Let them hear what a masterpiece sounds like!

Rau kicks a lever on an industrial-sized fan. It roars to life, sending a gale-force wind through the room. Parsley's hair blows wildly, nearly obscuring his face.

RAU (CONT'D)

(Shouting over the wind)
The wind-swept willow look!

PARSLEY

I cannot see! I'm gonna fall off
the—

A Tropical Rainforest screen falls on top of Parsley, while a Mountain Peak screen tangles around Rau.

RAU

(Muffled)

Don't move, Parsley! The lighting
is still perfect!

PARSLEY

The lighting is on fire!

A spark from the fallen lamp hits a nearby spray bottle of Leaf Glaze, which ignites like a mini-firework.

FLASH! FLASH! FLASH! The camera starts firing on its own,
capturing the absolute carnage.

Rau ecstatically emerges from the canvas.

RAU

Yes! This is it! Your face says
"Survival of the Fittest!"

The sprinkler system overhead clicks. A second later, the
room is hit with a downpour.

PARSLEY

(Sputtering)

Mom! We're being watered in the
house!

RAU

Stay in character, Parsley! You're
a cilantro in a storm!

FLASH!

The door swings open again. Oci stands there, jaw dropped,
holding a stack of hall passes as water pours out of the room
and into the hallway.

OCI

Is... everything okay in here?

RAU

Better than okay, Oci! We're making
history!

FLASH!

The final photo ejects from the camera, showing Parsley soaked, terrified, and accidentally holding a decorative garden gnome that fell from the shelf.

INT. ROOTIMENTARY SCHOOL - PRINCIPAL'S OFFICE

A photo of PRINCIPAL SEQUOIA hangs outside her office.

The fire alarm wails, competing with the roar of the sprinklers. The heavy oak doors at the back of the room slam open, framing Principal Sequoia. She is a towering Redwood whose bark-like skin has never cracked a smile. Her and Rau's silhouettes are seen through her office door.

PRINCIPAL SEQUOIA (O.S.)

This is the first time we've had
the parent in the hot seat.

RAU (O.S.)

Principal Sequoia, for a seat at
Salontro, we can provide your staff
a discount.

PRINCIPAL SEQUOIA (O.S.)

A discount for the destruction of
school property? The endangerment
of the student body? Or that I
found the real photographer tied up
in the janitor's closet?

Inside the office, Parsley sits besides Rau. He looks like a drowned herb.

PARSLEY

Mom, please stop talking.

RAU

They were a hack! Lighting the
students like common moss! That
photographer probably didn't have
kids

PRINCIPAL SEQUOIA

You are trespassing. And your son
is currently the only student in
Rootimentary history to have a
school photo featuring a hazardous
electrical fire in the background.

Sequoia points a branch-like finger towards the exit.

PRINCIPAL SEQUOIA (CONT'D)

Get. Out. Both of you. The "elite" board will be hearing about this, Ms. Ram. Your son's record is no longer picture perfect.

Parsley hangs his head, his bushy green hair dripping onto the floor. As they trudge past the Principal, Rau leans in, still clutching her camera.

RAU

You're just jealous because you don't have an "angle," you oversized stump!

Parsley squelches out of the office, leaving a trail of muddy water and charred leaves. The hallway is dead silent until he spots Pyrus leaning against a locker, clutching their stomach.

PYRUS

(Exploding into laughter)
Oh. My. Sap. Parsley, you look like a salad stuck in a sink drain!

PARSLEY

(Teeth chattering)
It's... not... funny.

Pyrus points a shaky finger at the soggy photo Parsley is clutching—the one where he's holding the garden gnome while the room burns.

PYRUS

You kidding? It's legendary! Look at your face! You look like you've seen the Great Mower in the sky!

BOMBUS

(Buzzing a mocking tune)
Bzz-bzz-LOSER-bzz!

PYRUS

Even Bombus thinks you've peaked. Forget the "elites," Parsley. This is the first time you've actually looked like you have a pulse!

RAU

(Marching past them)
Ignore the pear, Parsley! Art is always misunderstood by the fruit-bearing classes!

PYRUS

(Calling after them)

Art? Is that what we're calling a felony now? Hey, "Gnome-boy," wait up!

Pyrus trots after them, pulling out their own phone to snap a "candid" shot of Parsley's dripping hair.

Parsley stops mid-squelch. He looks at the soggy photo of himself clutching a gnome amidst an electrical fire. Then he looks at Pyrus. Slowly, a lopsided, mischievous grin spreads across his face.

PARSLEY

(Holding the photo up)

You're right. This isn't a disaster. It's an aesthetic.

PYRUS

(Eyes widening)

That's the spirit! Give me a pose, you beautiful disaster!

Parsley strikes a dramatic "survivor" pose, letting the sprinkler water drip off his nose like a high-fashion model. He turns to the crowd of staring students in the hallway.

PARSLEY

(Projecting)

Pre-orders for the "Gnome-boy Collection" start at lunch! Get 'em while they're hot—literally, the room is still on fire!

The hallway erupts. Some students cheer; others scramble to get their phones out. The Roses, previously so smug, look genuinely confused by his sudden confidence.

RAU

(Beaming)

That's my boy! Use the chaos to fertilize your brand!

PYRUS

(Recording a video)

First "Transplant" to ever break the internet before first period. We're going viral, Sprout!

Parsley marches toward the exit, head held high, squelching with every step like he's walking a runway in Woody Holly.

Principal Sequoia stands in the doorway, her massive wooden brow furrowing so deeply it looks like a canyon. She watches the spectacle—the cheering, the flashes, the sheer disrespect for her authoritarian order.

PRINCIPAL SEQUOIA
(Thundering)

THE NURSERY IS NOT A NIGHTCLUB, MR. RAM!

But the students aren't listening. They're too busy retweeting Pyrus's video. A tiny sprout in the back even starts a rhythmic chant: "Gnome-boy! Gnome-boy!"

RAU
(Winking at Sequoia)
Looks like your "elite" board just
got a new chairman, honey.

Rau grabs Parsley and Pyrus by the collars, ushering them toward the exit before Sequoia can find a reason to call the SAPP agents.

EXT. ROOTIMENTARY SCHOOL - MOMENTS LATER

They burst out of the greenhouse doors into the humid morning air. Malus is leaning against the wagon-car, blowing a cloud of sparkly pollen into the air.

MALUS
(Cackling)
I heard the fire alarm from three
blocks away. Rau, darling, tell me
you didn't just burn down the only
decent school in the district.

RAU
(Tossing the camera into
the backseat)
I didn't burn it down. I rebranded
it. Get in the car, we have a viral
moment to manage.

Parsley hops into the back, still dripping, but he's looking at his phone. The notification count is climbing. For the first time in his life, he doesn't feel like a "transplant" trying to blend in—he feels like a star.

PARSLEY
Mom?

RAU

Yes, my little masterpiece?

PARSLEY

Can we get some Miracle on the way home? I think I earned it.

Pyrus punches his arm, grinning.

PYRUS

He's finally growing some thorns!

Bombus gets out the Salontro cam. They buzz to the tune of "Photosynthesis."

COMPANY

Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...
Photo!

FLASH. The final photo captures [fill in the blank] and Parsley looking into the camera with a look that says: I'm just getting started.

On the bottom of the photo is a hand-written green text:
"Picture Perfect"

THE END

VISUAL CUE: The end credits feature a montage of all photos taken throughout the episode, interspersed with behind-the-scenes production stills and concept art. The images are a scrapbook of the adventure and spirit of *Photosynthesis*.